Michael Thomas

Senior Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience designing and operating distributed systems, workflow automation, and large-scale data pipelines in production. Experienced building reliable, event-driven systems that integrate with external services and file-based data sources, and leading projects from design through deployment while mentoring engineers and improving system reliability.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Go, Java, C#, TypeScript, SQL, Bash, Kotlin

Technologies: AWS, Docker, PlantUML, OpenAPI, Git, PostgreSQL, Angular, Node.js, Android

Focus areas: Distributed systems and workflow orchestration, event-driven architecture, database design and query performance, large-scale data pipelines and file processing, production reliability and incident response, technical mentorship and cross-functional collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sherpa 6 - Software Engineer III / Functional Lead *(Aug 2023 - Present)*

Startup environment building a mobile device management (MDM) platform for end-user devices, with small, semi-autonomous teams shipping quickly for diverse external clients.

- Designed and built a firmware update delivery system end-to-end: file-upload workflows, update-triggering pipelines, backend API and file-handling changes, and services to create and track individual device updates through completion.
- Designed and shipped a multi-stage application review system supporting multiple reviewers, staged approvals, and component signing mid-review, replacing a rigid single-stage workflow.
- Extended the platform's CI/CD validation process to support unapproved/pre-release applications without compromising production security, in collaboration with the team's deployment process.
- Promoted to Functional Lead; mentor engineers on the team through code review and technical discussions, and authored company-wide API development standards.
- Designed an independent, vendor-agnostic device configuration architecture, replacing hard-coded single-vendor logic to improve scalability and reliability as the platform grew.

Aiphone - Software Engineer II *(May 2023 - Aug 2023)*

Intercom and access control solutions with an expanding international online presence.

- Designed and implemented backend user management systems, cloud-based configuration systems, and billing services as part of a broader SaaS platform expansion, all built on AWS.

Amazon - Software Engineer I *(Feb 2022 - Feb 2023)*

Kindle reading platforms (Web Reading, Digital Delivery).

- Modernized a legacy content re-ingestion worker and built a Python automation tool to batch-trigger file re-ingestion by content ID, improving processing success rate by 30% across a high-volume, image-heavy file pipeline.
- Led 5 concurrent infrastructure migrations (OS, framework, language runtime, and service deprecations) across dozens of services and environments, including a CVE remediation, improving reliability and maintainability throughout.
- Reduced Sev-2 production incidents 12% year-over-year through targeted alarm tuning and monitoring standardization.
- Built a recurring mentorship program for a new Support Engineer, growing them to independently resolving 100% of their team's incident tickets within a year.

Amazon - Support Engineer (L4) *(May 2019 - Feb 2022)*

Kindle reading platforms (Web Reading, Digital Delivery) - owned reliability for 27 production services.

- Reverse-engineered an undocumented legacy manifest-generation service and led the design and build of its replacement with 100% test coverage, supporting an average of 8.4M+ daily requests with zero written specification to start from.
- Designed the migration architecture for a decade-old feature off a deprecated internal platform, decomposing it into 5 independently-buildable components plus shared logic, then documented it well enough for a new 8-engineer team to build against it and hit a hard deadline.
- Root-caused and fixed an authentication-bypass vulnerability escalated by an external security researcher, protecting up to 475,915 daily users.

Microsoft - Lab Engineer *(Jan 2015 - Oct 2018)*

Hardware testing lab supporting server and desktop infrastructure for device and software validation.

- Designed and implemented custom monitoring software to generate automated alerts and health reporting across a server/desktop fleet.
- Built object-oriented automation to replace manually executed operational tasks, reducing manual overhead for the team.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science - Bellevue College

Sep 2018 - May 2021